



A Quick Look At Ubuntu Studio 10.10

Ubuntu has a large and growing variety of flavours. Ubuntu Studio is a useful Ubuntu derivative targeted at multimedia artists. If you're a professional, or need applications to create/edit images, video and audio, then this is your perfect companion.

There's no denying the fact that most users prefer to perform their multimedia tasks using Windows. This article does not preach about how FOSS apps are better than closed-source apps like Adobe Photoshop, or even Windows Movie Maker. Instead, I hope to enlighten those who were unaware that they can use free and open source alternatives to do the same work they use proprietary Windows apps for.

Ubuntu Studio is bundled with a large number of applications, which are useful for multimedia-based project work.

Graphics

There are image-editing tools like the GIMP (GNU Image Manipulation Program), which is a great alternative to Adobe Photoshop. For vector graphics editing, there is Inkscape. Other graphics tools provided include F-Spot (an image organiser), XSane (a graphical scanning

frontend to SANE, which stands for 'scanner access now easy'. It uses the SANE-library to talk to scanners), and Hugin (a panorama photo stitcher).

Video

A collection of video applications are provided, including Freemix, Kino, xjadeo, Stopmotion and a subtitle editor.

Audio

A wide range of audio production tools are present, like, JACK audio tools, Beast, Muse, Audacity and so on.

System requirements

The system requirements for Ubuntu Studio are the same as for Ubuntu. However, it is recommended that you have enough memory and a good processor, if you intend to do intensive multimedia work like video rendering, multi-track audio recording, etc.